

Monthly Current Affairs Digest - September 2026

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1. National & International News Highlights

International Affairs

- **81st Session of the UN General Assembly (UNGA 81):** World leaders convened at the UN Headquarters in New York under the theme *"Rebuilding Multilateral Trust: Accelerating Sustainable Growth and Ethical AI Governance."* Key discussions focused on global climate finance mechanisms and global standards for frontier artificial intelligence models.
- **Indo-Pacific Maritime Security Pact Expanded:** Member states of the Quad (India, US, Japan, Australia) announced the full operationalization of the **IPMDA-2 (Indo-Pacific Partnership for Maritime Domain Awareness Phase 2)**, integrating satellite radar tracking with autonomous sea drones to combat illegal fishing and enhance search-and-rescue operations.
- **Global Treaty on Plastic Pollution Finalized:** Negotiators at the UN Environment Programme (UNEP) summit in Geneva agreed on a legally binding global instrument to phase out single-use plastics by 2035, introducing standardized mandatory recycling targets for major industrial nations.

National News (India Focus)

- **Inauguration of the Western Dedicated Freight Corridor (WDFC) Final Phase:** The Ministry of Railways officially marked the 100% completion and operationalization of the WDFC, connecting Dadri (Uttar Pradesh) to Jawaharlal Nehru Port Trust (JNPT, Mumbai), significantly reducing freight transit times across northern and western India.
 - **National Urban Transit Expansion:** Phase II of three major metro networks (Bengaluru, Ahmedabad, and Patna) was operationalized simultaneously, adding over 110 km of driverless metro lines across urban corridors.
 - **Cabinet Approves High-Speed Rail Corridor Expansion:** The Union Cabinet approved two new high-speed rail corridors connecting Mumbai–Hyderabad and New Delhi–Varanasi, with construction scheduled to begin by early 2027.
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2. Economy & Business Developments

Macroeconomics & Global Trade

- **IMF-World Bank Joint Outlook:** The International Monetary Fund (IMF) revised global growth projections for late 2026 to 3.3%, citing resilient consumer demand in emerging markets and gains in industrial productivity driven by automation and green energy transitions.

- **Cross-Border CBDC Project "mBridge" Commercial Scale Launch:** The Bank for International Settlements (BIS) alongside participating central banks announced the multi-currency Central Bank Digital Currency (CBDC) platform is fully open for commercial cross-border trade settlements, reducing transaction settlement times from days to seconds.

Banking, Finance & Industry

- **India's First Commercial Semiconductor Fab Begins Pilot Production:** The semiconductor fabrication facility in Dholera, Gujarat, produced its first operational 28nm silicon wafers, marking a major milestone in national microchip self-reliance.
- **India's Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) Export Hub:** India signed bilateral MoUs with three South American nations to export its open-source tech stack, including unified payments, digital identity systems, and digital consent frameworks.
- **Green Bond Issuance Hits Record High:** Global sovereign green bond issuances surpassed \$1.2 trillion for the year by late September, led by renewable infrastructure, grid modernization, and urban green building initiatives.

3. Science, Technology & Environment

Space Exploration

- **ISRO Gaganyaan Human Spaceflight Mission (G-1 Prep):** ISRO successfully completed the final uncrewed orbital test flight (G1-X) incorporating the upgraded environmental control and life support system (ECLSS), clearing the path for India's upcoming crewed orbital flight.
- **Artemis IV Mission Progress:** NASA and its international partners integrated the main module for the Gateway lunar space station in orbit, establishing the primary staging point for upcoming deep-space crewed landings.

Emerging Technologies & AI

- **1,000-Logical-Qubit Quantum Processor Unveiled:** A international consortium of quantum researchers demonstrated the first error-corrected quantum computing platform exceeding 1,000 logical qubits, showcasing practical applications in molecular dynamic simulation and cryptography.
- **Global Frontier AI Compact Enacted:** Leading technology companies and regulatory bodies formally agreed on universal watermarking standards and mandatory safety audits for multimodal AI systems capable of autonomous tool usage.

Environment & Clean Energy

- **Breakthrough in Solid-State Sodium-Ion Batteries:** Researchers announced a commercial-grade solid-state sodium-ion battery featuring an energy density of 240 Wh/kg without using cobalt or nickel, significantly lowering electric vehicle battery production costs.
- **Commissioning of World's Largest Hybrid Solar-Wind Facility:** A 10-Gigawatt (GW) hybrid renewable energy park was fully synchronized to the grid in Western Rajasthan, equipped with utility-scale battery energy storage systems (BESS).

4. Government Schemes & Policies

National Policy Updates

- **PM-Surya Ghar 2.0 Extended Framework:** The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy launched Phase 2 of the rooftop solar initiative, introducing direct financial micro-incentives for community microgrids and rural agricultural feeder solarization.
- **National Green Hydrogen Mission - Phase II Targets:** The Ministry of Power released guidelines for setting up green ammonia and green methanol bunkering hubs across major commercial ports to support international zero-emission maritime routes.
- **Skill India Digital 3.0 Launch:** The Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship launched an upgraded digital learning framework offering industry-aligned certifications in AI systems engineering, precision agriculture, and quantum programming.

Health & Rural Development

- **National Digital Health Grid Expansion (ABDM):** The Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission achieved universal integration across all primary healthcare centers (PHCs) nationwide, introducing AI-assisted tele-diagnostics for remote health monitoring.
- **Clean Water Initiative Milestone:** The Jal Jeevan Mission reached a major milestone, certifying over 85% of rural households with functional household tap connections (FHTC) across India.

5. Important Dates & Awards

Key International & National Days (September 2026)

| Date | Day / Observance | Theme / Significance |

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| **Sept 5** | National Teachers' Day (India) | Honors the birth anniversary of Dr. Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan. |

| **Sept 8** | International Literacy Day | *Focus:* Promoting Literacy in the Digital and AI Era. |

| **Sept 15** | National Engineers' Day (India) | Commemorates the birth anniversary of Sir M. Visvesvaraya. |

| **Sept 15** | International Day of Democracy | *Focus:* Ensuring Inclusive Governance and Digital Rights. |

| **Sept 16** | World Ozone Day | Marks the anniversary of the Montreal Protocol on substances that deplete the ozone layer. |

| **Sept 21** | International Day of Peace | Global observance dedicated to non-violence and ceasefires. |

| **Sept 27** | World Tourism Day | *Focus:* Sustainable Tourism & Green Investments. |

Awards & Recognitions

- **Ramon Magsaysay Awards 2026:** Announced for community leadership, civil activism, and innovative grass-roots solutions across the Asian region.
- **Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar (National Science Awards):** Awarded by the President of India to prominent scientists and innovators in fields including space science, atomic energy, engineering, and sustainable technologies.
- **UN Global Climate Action Award:** Presented to cross-national consortia developing decentralized renewable energy systems in climate-vulnerable coastal regions.